THANDO MKHIZE

Elderly Resident Support & Activities Volunteer

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Address: 25 Smith Street, Durban, KwaZulu-Natal, South Africa

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Compassionate and dependable volunteer with practical experience supporting elderly residents and community members through companionship, social interaction and recreational activities. Strong communication, active listening, empathy, patience and teamwork skills. Experienced in assisting with resident activities, reading sessions, games, arts and crafts, event preparation and basic activity records. Committed to protecting resident dignity, privacy and wellbeing while working under staff guidance.

CAREER OBJECTIVE

To contribute my compassion, communication and resident-support skills as an **Elderly Resident Companion & Activities Volunteer**, helping residents feel respected, included and socially connected while supporting staff with safe, non-medical activities.

CORE SKILLS

- Companionship
- Elderly Resident Support
- Resident Support
- Empathy
- Patience
- Communication
- Active Listening
- Interpersonal Skills
- Recreational Activities
- Activity Coordination
- Games and Puzzles
- Reading Activities
- Arts and Crafts
- Teamwork
- Organisation
- Time Management
- Problem Solving
- Reliability

- Event Support
- Basic Administration
- Confidentiality
- Social Interaction

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Resident Activities Volunteer
Durban Community Care Centre
January 2025 – August 2026

- Provided friendly companionship and conversation to elderly residents during scheduled volunteer sessions.
- Assisted residents with games, puzzles, reading sessions and simple recreational activities.
- Supported arts-and-crafts sessions and helped prepare activity materials.
- Encouraged residents to participate in appropriate social activities while respecting individual preferences.
- Helped staff prepare activity areas for resident events and entertainment sessions.
- Listened respectfully to residents and reported concerns to the responsible staff member.
- Maintained simple activity attendance and participation records.
- Worked with staff and other volunteers to create a welcoming and respectful environment.

Community Support Volunteer
KwaZulu Community Support Initiative
March 2024 – December 2024

- Supported elderly and community members during social and recreational programmes.
- Assisted with community games, group activities and small events.
- Provided patient one-to-one conversation and active listening.
- Helped organise materials, participant lists and activity spaces.
- Communicated respectfully with participants, families, staff and fellow volunteers.
- Followed instructions and maintained appropriate boundaries when supporting vulnerable people.

Youth & Community Activities Volunteer
Durban Community Outreach Programme
June 2023 – February 2024

- Assisted with group activities, community events and social programmes.
- Helped participants register for activities and maintained basic records.
- Worked as part of a volunteer team to prepare and run activities.
- Developed strong communication, patience, organisation and interpersonal skills.

EDUCATION

National Senior Certificate (Matric)
Durban Secondary School — 2022

Subjects:

- English
- Life Orientation
- Business Studies
- Computer Applications Technology

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certificate in Community Development and Volunteer Support — KwaZulu Training Institute, 2024
- Basic First Aid Certificate — South African First Aid Training Centre, 2024

LANGUAGES

- English — Fluent
- isiZulu — Native
- Afrikaans — Basic

VOLUNTEER ACTIVITIES

Community Event Volunteer
Durban Community Outreach Programme — 2023–2024

Resident Social Activities Volunteer
Durban Community Care Centre — 2025–2026

REFERENCES

Nomusa Dlamini
Community Programme Coordinator
Durban Community Care Centre
+27 71 234 5678

Sibusiso Ndlovu
Volunteer Coordinator
KwaZulu Community Support Initiative
+27 73 345 6789